

Intro-Entertainment Industry ~ Active Listening and Trade Sites

Statistic for the Day

In 2023, arts and cultural industries contributed **\$1.2 trillion** to the U.S. economy, representing **4.2% of the nation's GDP** and supporting **5.4 million jobs**, according to the National

Endowment for the Arts, [reports the Mass Cultural Council](#). This economic impact is significant and continues to grow, with the arts sector contributing more than the transportation and warehousing sectors, for example.

Take a look at this [Economic Activity Study](#) of Metro Denver Culture. Browse through the findings with a partner. Find a statistic or two that you find compelling, and I'll ask you to share it with the group to kick off our discussion.

Listening - A Critical Job Skill

- Developing good listening skills will give you an advantage in almost any job in the entertainment industry
- The entertainment industry thrives through great communication
- Being a great listener will help you succeed in any job, but it is particularly important in the entertainment industry, where time is money, and it's important to not only digest information quickly but also think about it critically and incorporate it into a creative response
- Read this article on [10 Critical Listening Tips for the Workplace](#)
- Do these suggestions ring true to you? Or do you think they create the appearance of listening? Let's talk about it!
- Now let's watch this [Video on The Art of Active Listening](#)
- Truly active listening is *exactly* what artists need when we're working together in a creative space

When you become a good listener, you will:

- Build trust with your colleagues

- Solve problems more efficiently
- Learn something
- Become more patient
- Enhance the creativity of the entire group (more voices contributing to the whole)
- Save Time and Money

Trade Sites

- Here are some possible trade sites for your upcoming **Trade Website Assignment**
 - www.actorsequity.org
 - www.sagaftra.org
 - www.iatse7denver.org
 - www.usitt.org
 - www.ileahub.com
- Answer the following questions:
 - What is the main purpose of this organization?
 - What questions did you have about this group? Were you able to find answers?
 - How do you become a member?